LAME BRAIN

ideas

Prospectus & Feasibility Study

A staged path from idea-development studio to a validated venture platform

"Ever have one? Come on in."

INVESTMENT-COMMITTEE CONCLUSION

CONDITIONAL GO for a 90-day paid pop-up and concierge studio. NO-GO for a long-term flagship lease, proprietary funding platform, investor marketplace, or franchise rollout until the validation gates in this prospectus are met.

Prepared 17 July 2026 | Version 1.0 | United States planning basis

This document is a planning prospectus and feasibility study. It is not an offer to sell securities, audited financial statements, a valuation, legal advice, tax advice, or an assurance of future performance.

AT A GLANCE

01 Executive decision

THE RECOMMENDATION

Launch the smallest paid version that can prove willingness to pay, delivery quality, confidentiality, and repeatable economics. Preserve the storefront vision as a tested destination—not as the first irreversible cost.

Lame Brain Ideas can occupy a real gap between free mentoring, do-it-yourself AI, specialist consulting, incubators, and crowdfunding platforms. The gap is not "advice." It is a confidential, guided transformation from an unstructured idea into decision-ready artifacts: problem definition, evidence, concept options, prototype or pitch, execution plan, and an honest next-step recommendation.

The original source concept is emotionally legible and retail-friendly: a place where ordinary people can walk in with an idea and leave with progress. The proposed three exits—take the package home, pursue rewards crowdfunding, or enter an investor pathway—are compelling when they are separated by clear gates. They become legally and operationally hazardous if they are bundled as one promise.

Decision lens	Finding	Implication
Customer need	Plausible, not yet measured	Test paid demand before a lease
Service feasibility	High for a concierge studio	Codify scope, QA, and handoffs
Flagship economics	**Weak in base case**	**Do not fund on walk-in optimism**
Platform feasibility	Conditional and regulated	Partner first; build later
Scalability	Unproven	Replicate only after store-level proof

Financial reality

Scenario	Year 5 revenue	Year 5 EBITDA	Margin	Funding need	Break-even
Downside	$1.345M	($611K)	(45.4%)	$5.128M	Beyond Y5
Base	**$2.010M**	**$75K**	**3.7%**	**$2.648M**	**Year 5**
Upside	$2.497M	$402K	16.1%	$2.116M	Year 4

Source: management-assumption financial model accompanying this prospectus. Figures are unlevered and rounded.

WHAT IS BEING EVALUATED

02 Source concept and strategic reframing

What the source actually contains

The public ChatGPT share titled “Lame Brain Ideas Plan” contains one user concept prompt and one assistant response. No Canvas documents, attachments, financial files, operating manuals, or brand assets were recoverable. This prospectus therefore treats the user’s prompt as source intent and the assistant response as a set of hypotheses—not as approved strategy or evidence.

The source proposes a hip, approachable storefront—part Apple Store, Brookstone, Kickstarter, and Shark Tank—with employees called Brain Stormers, private idea intake, AI-enabled development, and three possible exits. The prior response added tiered packages, studio zones, proprietary AI engines, memberships, city targets, crowdfunding fees, investor memberships, and franchising. Those additions are useful design prompts but require validation.

The investable reframing

CATEGORY
A guided idea-development studio with retail hospitality—not a retail store that happens to sell consulting.

- Customer promise: turn ambiguity into evidence, artifacts, and a decision.
- Operating unit: scoped professional-service engagements delivered through a repeatable studio workflow.
- Experience advantage: easy walk-in language, tangible outputs, private rooms, workshops, and visible progress.
- Platform option: rewards crowdfunding and investor introductions only after service quality, demand, and compliance are proven.

Three exits, three distinct products

Exit	Customer outcome	Business role	Gate
Take-home package	Research, concept, plan, prototype/pitch	Core revenue	Available from day one
Rewards launch	Campaign-ready assets and launch plan	Service + partner referral	Product and fulfillment readiness
Investor pathway	Finance-ready materials and curated introductions	Later-phase membership/network	Specialist legal design and qualified companies

EVIDENCE BEFORE TAM

03 Market context

There is a large, renewing universe of people and firms forming, testing, and improving businesses. That is evidence of activity, not proof that Lame Brain Ideas can capture a fixed percentage. This study avoids a fictional top-down market-size claim and instead uses a bottom-up paid pilot to measure addressable demand by segment, channel, package, and location.

Signal	Current evidence	Meaning for Lame Brain Ideas
Small-business universe	36,207,130 U.S. small businesses; 82.3% are nonemployers [S1]	Large fragmented audience; many have limited staff capacity
Formation intent	531,423 seasonally adjusted business applications in June 2026 [S2]	A recurring upper funnel, not equivalent to paying customers
Near-term formation	29,741 projected payroll startups within four quarters from the June cohort [S2]	Qualification matters; only a fraction progress
AI adoption	7.6% of small businesses used AI during Sep 2024–Aug 2025; 8.2% among firms with fewer than five employees [S1]	AI interest is real, but adoption remains uneven
Business mortality	49.2% of establishments born in 2018 survived five years [S1]	Customers need honest kill/pivot decisions, not encouragement theater

Why customers might pay

- They lack a sequence: AI can generate options, but not an accountable process or a credible stop decision.
- They need tangible outputs: evidence logs, positioning, prototypes, scope, economics, launch plan, and pitch materials.
- They value confidence and speed: a facilitated sprint can replace weeks of fragmented searching and tool hopping.
- They need discretion: sensitive ideas require explicit data handling, consent, access, retention, and deletion controls.

Bottom-up demand test

The pilot should run a geo-coded funnel by audience and acquisition channel. The real serviceable market is the set of qualified prospects within the pilot catchment who convert at a sustainable acquisition cost, complete a scoped engagement, and produce sufficient revenue per delivery hour. Every marketing claim and capital decision should be downstream of that evidence.

WHO BUYS FIRST

04 Customer segmentation and beachhead

Segment	Job to be done	Best entry offer	Priority
Aspiring founder	Decide whether an idea is worth pursuing	$99 diagnostic → $649 sprint	Primary
Existing microbusiness	Validate a new offer, channel, or operational improvement	$649 sprint → $3,750 build	Primary
Professional innovator	Turn domain insight into a credible side venture	$649 sprint	Secondary
Student/team	Structure a capstone, competition, or venture	Workshop / sponsored cohort	Secondary
Investor-ready company	Prepare data room, model, story, and introductions	$12,500 launch studio	Later, gated

Recommended beachhead

FIRST WEDGE

Local aspiring founders and existing microbusiness owners with a specific decision to make within 30 days. They are reachable through libraries, SBDCs, chambers, universities, coworking spaces, maker communities, and professional associations.

The beachhead excludes highly regulated products, complex patent strategy, medical claims, defense applications, and customers expecting guaranteed funding. These cases can be referred to specialists until the studio has a mature expert network.

Buyer objections to test

- "Why not use ChatGPT myself?"—answer with facilitation, evidence, synthesis, accountability, and artifact quality.
- "Why not use SCORE or an SBDC?"—answer with paid speed, production, prototyping, and a defined deliverable; do not disparage free partners.
- "Will you steal or train on my idea?"—answer with a plain-language confidentiality and AI-data policy.
- "Can you get me funded?"—answer with qualification criteria and no guarantee.

THE SUBSTITUTE IS THE REAL COMPETITOR

05 Competitive landscape

Alternative	Strength	Gap Lame Brain can address
SCORE / SBDC	Free mentoring and technical assistance [S3][S4]	Production speed, tangible artifacts, retail access, guided AI
Solo AI tools	Cheap, immediate ideation and drafting	Scope control, evidence, accountability, privacy choices, expert review
Freelancers / consultants	Deep specialty and custom delivery	Integrated front door, packaged process, accessible language
Incubators / accelerators	Network, cohort, credibility, capital access	Walk-in accessibility; help before an application-ready venture exists
Maker spaces / studios	Equipment and hands-on prototyping	Business validation, story, launch plan, coordinated specialists
Kickstarter / Indiegogo	Audience and campaign infrastructure	Pre-campaign validation and production; platform fees are 5% plus processing [S5][S6]
Coworking / workshops	Community and events	Accountable end-to-end deliverable

Defensible advantage

The moat is not an AI prompt library. It is the compounding operating system around intake, scope, research provenance, human judgment, specialist routing, reusable templates, privacy controls, outcome measurement, and a trusted local network. The studio should be able to show how it reached a recommendation and where uncertainty remains.

POSITIONING

A place where your idea gets worked—not merely admired, generated, or pitched.

Brand risk

“Lame Brain” is memorable and self-deprecating, but it may be heard as insulting or ableist. Treat the mark, domain, trademark availability, and customer interpretation as unvalidated. Run blind name tests before investing in signage or filing strategy; retain the category promise even if the name changes.

SELL A DECISION, NOT HOURS

06 Offer architecture and pricing

Offer	Working price	Delivery hours	Core output	Conversion role
Quick Diagnostic	$99	1	Decision brief, unknowns, next step	Paid qualification
Idea Sprint	$649	4	Problem evidence, concept options, scorecard, plan	Core entry product
Venture Build	$3,750	20	Research, proposition, prototype/pitch, economics	Main project product
Launch Studio	$12,500	60	Campaign/fundraising readiness package	Selective premium product
Founder Membership	$99/mo	Gated	Office hours, accountability, events, lab access	Recurring relationship

All prices are working assumptions, not market evidence. The accompanying workbook calculates service revenue from capacity, utilization, delivery hours, and package mix.

Scope controls

- Every engagement starts with a signed statement of work, decision question, deliverable list, exclusions, customer responsibilities, and revision limit.
- Specialist work—legal, patent, engineering certification, clinical, tax, regulated claims—requires a qualified provider and separate scope.
- The studio owns its methods and templates; the customer owns paid-for custom deliverables subject to licensed inputs and third-party rights.
- A kill or pause recommendation is a successful outcome when evidence does not support further spend.

Pricing experiments

Test three price cells for the Idea Sprint ($499, $649, $799) and two formats (in-person and hybrid). Measure conversion, completion time, realized revenue per delivery hour, customer-reported value, referral, rework, and downstream package conversion. Do not discount Launch Studio until the team can estimate delivery variance.

RETAIL HOSPITALITY, PROFESSIONAL DISCIPLINE

07 Customer journey and studio experience

1. Welcome and fit check: a host translates the idea into a decision question and screens prohibited or specialist-only work.
2. Confidential intake: the customer chooses data-sharing and AI-processing permissions before any sensitive content is entered.
3. Paid diagnostic: a Brain Stormer identifies evidence gaps, risks, and the best next package.
4. Build sprint: facilitated research, synthesis, concept development, and prototype/pitch creation, with visible milestones.
5. Red-team review: a second reviewer checks evidence, claims, feasibility, scope, and customer-ready quality.
6. Exit decision: take the package, enter a rewards-launch pathway, enter a legally designed investor-readiness pathway, pause, or stop.

Physical format

Pilot pop-up	Modeled flagship
800–1,200 sq. ft. or partner-hosted	3,200 sq. ft. visible service location
One welcome/meeting area plus two private rooms	Welcome bar, private build rooms, flex workshop, prototype bench
Light buildout; movable furniture; short commitment	Modeled at $560K leasehold improvements plus $260K equipment/technology
Goal: prove demand and workflow	Goal: deliver at scale after economics are proven

A suburban mixed-use, university-adjacent, or neighborhood center may offer better parking, recurring local traffic, and lower occupancy risk than a prestige downtown flagship. CBRE reported average U.S. retail asking rent of $24.59 per square foot and 4.9% availability in Q1 2026; the model uses $30 base rent plus $9 NNN/CAM to reflect a visible service location [S7]. Local broker proposals must replace this national benchmark.

A SERVICES ENGINE IN A STOREFRONT SHELL

08 Operating model and staffing

The base model assumes five delivery FTEs: one store GM/senior practitioner and four Brain Stormers. It also includes community/operations support and one-half prototype specialist FTE. This staffing is intentionally senior because customers are paying for judgment and synthesis, not access to software.

Role	Base assumption	Accountability
Store GM / Senior Brain Surgeon	$120K salary	P&L, QA, difficult engagements, team utilization
Brain Stormer ×4	$78K each	Intake, research, synthesis, facilitation, delivery
Community / operations	$75K	Events, scheduling, partners, customer operations
Prototype specialist, 0.5 FTE	$90K full-time equivalent	Mockups, lab workflow, specialist routing
Benefits and payroll burden	20%	Modeled on salaries

BLS reported May 2024 median pay of $101,190 for management analysts and $76,950 for market research analysts. These are national occupational anchors, not local offers or proof of recruiting supply [S8][S9].

Standard delivery workflow

- Intake → scope → consent → evidence plan → build → red-team → customer review → exit recommendation → outcome follow-up.
- Every deliverable carries a version, owner, source log, assumptions, unresolved questions, and human approver.
- Utilization is measured on paid client delivery hours; coaching, training, sales, R&D, and quality review are planned separately.
- No employee is paid based on investment dollars raised or securities transactions without specialized legal approval.

HOW THE WORK SHOULD BE GOVERNED

09 Agentic roles and project skills

Assigned role	Core skills	Decision/output
Managing Partner / IC Lead	strategy, synthesis, stage gates	Go/no-go and capital sequence
Venture Architect	business model, offer design, experimentation	Service ladder and validation plan
Market Research Lead	primary-source research, segmentation, competitor mapping	Evidence register and beachhead
Retail Experience & Operations Lead	service design, staffing, site operations	Journey, footprint, SOPs
Financial Modeling & Feasibility Lead	unit economics, scenarios, cash planning	Five-year model and checks
Product & AI Systems Architect	workflow, data governance, tooling, provenance	Secure human-in-the-loop platform
Risk/IP/Regulatory Workstream Lead	issue spotting, control design, specialist routing	Risk register and counsel briefs
Brand & CX Strategist	naming, positioning, retail communication	Name test and messaging
Evidence & Deliverable Steward	versioning, QA, source hygiene	Decision-ready artifact set

REQUIRED EXTERNAL SPECIALISTS

Startup/securities counsel, IP counsel, privacy/security counsel, CPA/tax adviser, commercial real-estate broker, architect/contractor, insurance broker, and—in later phases—an SEC-registered intermediary. Agentic work prepares evidence and briefs; it does not replace licensed advice.

Decision rules

- Source intent is preserved; assistant-generated additions remain hypotheses until approved or validated.
- Primary sources outrank market-size marketing pages and unattributed benchmarks.
- Financial inputs are editable assumptions; formulas, checks, and source notes are visible.
- No downstream funding or expansion stage may hide upstream service-economics failure.

TRUST IS PART OF THE PRODUCT

10 AI, data, and intellectual-property architecture

The safest initial architecture is a controlled service workspace, not a customer-facing autonomous "idea engine." Human practitioners select tools, document sources and assumptions, and approve customer deliverables. The NIST AI Risk Management Framework provides a voluntary structure for managing AI risks and should inform governance [S10].

Control domain	Minimum launch control
Consent	Separate confidentiality agreement, service terms, and explicit AI-processing choices
Data classification	Public, internal, confidential, highly restricted; prohibited data categories defined
Model access	Approved enterprise/API tools; training on customer data disabled where contractually available
Access	Least privilege, MFA, role-based workspaces, encrypted storage and transfer
Retention	Customer-visible retention period, deletion workflow, backup handling, legal holds
Provenance	Source log, prompt/output trace where appropriate, licensed asset record, human sign-off
Quality	Evidence check, hallucination check, claims review, second-person red-team on premium work
Incident response	Owner, escalation tree, customer notice criteria, preserved logs, postmortem

IP posture

Do not promise that an AI-assisted output is automatically protectable. The U.S. Copyright Office has emphasized human authorship, and the USPTO's revised inventorship guidance states that only natural persons may be named inventors while AI may function as a tool [S11][S12]. Record meaningful human contributions, third-party inputs, licenses, and invention chronology. Route patentability, freedom-to-operate, trademark, and ownership questions to counsel.

SEPARATE SERVICE, LAUNCH, AND SECURITIES LANES

11 Regulatory and legal feasibility

Area	Risk	Phase-appropriate response
Confidentiality	Ideas may include trade secrets or personal data	Plain-language NDA, intake choices, secure workflow, no blanket secrecy claims
IP ownership	Mixed human/AI/third-party contributions	Engagement terms, provenance, assignment/license language, counsel review
Rewards crowdfunding	Fulfillment, consumer claims, platform rules	Prepare campaigns; use established platforms; verify claims and budgets
Securities crowdfunding	Offering, intermediary, communications, compensation	Use one SEC-registered broker-dealer or funding portal; specialist counsel [S13]
Investor community	Broker/dealer, adviser, solicitation, conflicts	No transaction-based compensation; design referral and membership model with counsel
Franchising	Franchise Rule disclosure and state laws	Defer; obtain franchise counsel and FDD strategy before offering franchises [S14]
Customer claims	“Validated,” “investable,” or “fundable” can mislead	Define criteria, disclose uncertainty, prohibit guarantees

Regulation Crowdfunding permits eligible companies to raise up to $5 million in a 12-month period, but transactions must occur through a single SEC-registered intermediary [S13]. SEC statistics through 31 December 2025 show 9,461 filed offerings, 4,303 offerings reporting proceeds, and $1.546 billion in reported proceeds—evidence that the channel exists, not proof that a new studio should operate the channel [S15].

BOUNDARY

In the first phase, Lame Brain Ideas sells development services. It does not hold customer funds, promise capital, operate a securities marketplace, recommend securities, or receive transaction-based compensation.

BUILD TRUSTED DISTRIBUTION BEFORE PAID MEDIA SCALE

12 Go-to-market and partnerships

Channel sequence

1. Founder-led discovery: 40–60 interviews and 12 paid concierge engagements across the two primary segments.
2. Partner-hosted clinics: libraries, SBDCs, SCORE chapters, universities, chambers, coworking spaces, maker communities, and professional groups.
3. Pop-up acquisition: short-run storefront or embedded studio with geo-coded booking, transparent packages, and weekly workshops.
4. Referral engine: alumni introductions, expert partners, accountants, attorneys, designers, engineers, and local lenders—subject to conflict and compensation rules.
5. Selective paid acquisition: only after segment-level conversion, contribution, and payback are measured.

Partner posture

SCORE offers no-cost, confidential mentoring, and SBDCs provide individualized advising and technical assistance [S3][S4]. These organizations are natural complements and referral partners. Lame Brain Ideas should sell structured production and speed around—rather than compete with—their public-service value.

Metric	Pilot target	Why it matters
Qualified lead → paid diagnostic	≥20%	Demand and message fit
Diagnostic → Idea Sprint+	≥35%	Value ladder conversion
Blended service revenue / delivery hour	≥$200	Labor and occupancy capacity
Customer acquisition payback	≤90 days	Capital-efficient growth
Referral / repeat share	≥30% by month 6	Trust and durable demand
NPS	≥50	Experience and referral potential
Critical privacy/confidentiality incidents	0	License to operate

CAPACITY BEFORE OPTIMISM

13 Financial model design

The financial model is a single-store, unlevered planning model with five full operating years. It uses service capacity, utilization, delivery hours, prices, package mix, memberships, later-stage gated revenue, staffing, occupancy, operating expenses, startup uses, working capital, and maintenance capital. It is not a valuation and does not assume debt service or net operating loss tax benefits.

Driver	Base assumption	Interpretation
Delivery capacity	5 FTE × 1,450 client hours = 7,250 hours	Annual practical capacity before utilization
Paid utilization	38%, 52%, 65%, 75%, 82%	Aggressive maturation; must be measured
Service mix	15% / 35% / 32% / 18% by hours	Quick / Sprint / Build / Launch
Weighted service rate	$169 per paid client hour	Based on working prices and package mix
Membership	$99 per month	110 average members in Y1 to 420 in Y5
Occupancy	3,200 sq. ft.; $30 rent + $9 NNN/CAM	Visible service location; local quotes required
Opening uses	$995K	$560K buildout plus FF&E, tech, pre-open, deposits
Minimum cash buffer	$250K	Financing need preserves this balance

Service gross margin appears high because most delivery payroll is treated as fixed operating expense. The management focus should therefore be paid utilization, realized revenue per paid hour, project variance, and gross profit after specialist pass-through—not gross margin alone.

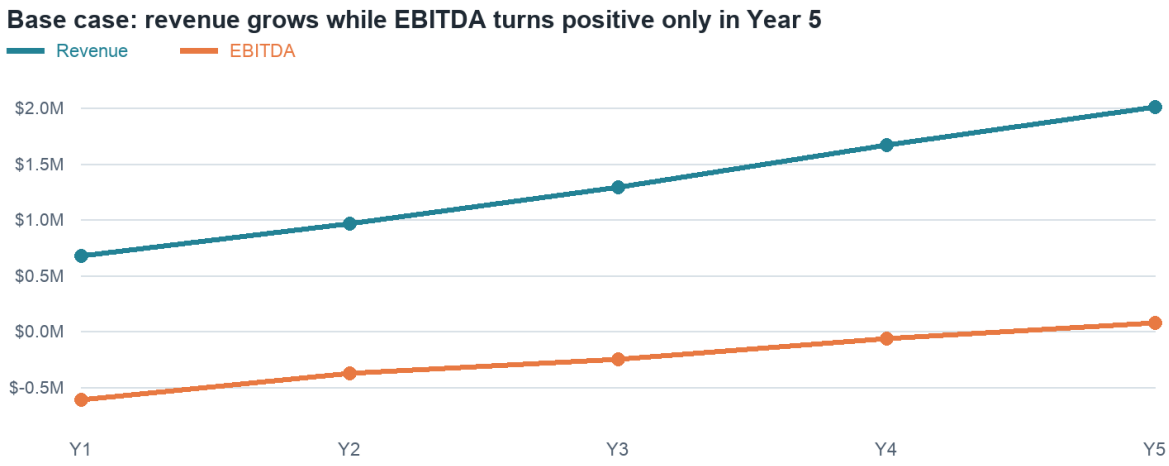
MODEL USE

Edit blue assumption cells, review green cross-sheet formulas, and keep the Checks sheet at PASS. Replace management assumptions with signed quotes, actual invoices, and measured funnel data as they become available.

BASE CASE

14 Five-year single-store projection

USD	Year 1	Year 2	Year 3	Year 4	Year 5
Revenue	$673,932	$967,500	$1,289,705	$1,672,180	$2,009,924
Gross profit	$582,823	$836,244	$1,106,852	$1,413,694	$1,682,519
Operating expenses	$1,197,200	$1,209,066	$1,357,248	$1,476,814	$1,607,837
EBITDA	**($614,377)**	**($372,822)**	**($250,396)**	**($63,120)**	**$74,681**
EBITDA margin	(91.2%)	(38.5%)	(19.4%)	(3.8%)	3.7%
Net income	($778,377)	($538,844)	($419,320)	($235,914)	($103,129)



Base case reaches positive EBITDA in Year 5, but net income remains negative after depreciation. Revenue includes gated rewards-platform fees beginning Year 3 and investor memberships beginning Year 4.

Interpretation

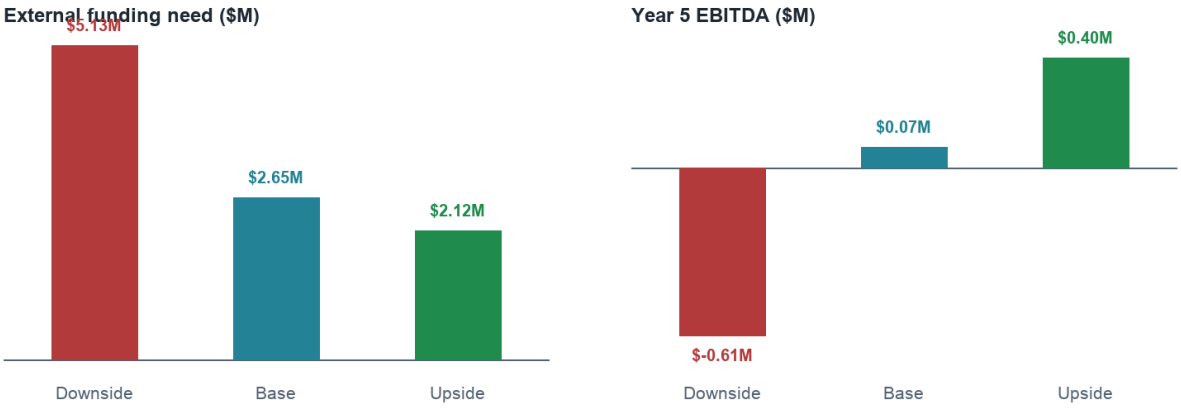
The flagship is not attractive as a conventional store rollout on the base assumptions. It consumes capital for four operating years and reaches only a 3.7% Year 5 EBITDA margin. The model can become compelling only if the pilot proves higher realized pricing, materially better utilization, leaner fixed staffing, or a scalable recurring product without sacrificing trust and quality.

CAPITAL MUST FOLLOW EVIDENCE

15 Funding need and scenario sensitivity

Base funding use	Amount	% of $2.648M
Opening uses	$995,000	37.6%
Operating ramp / working capital	$1,403,209	53.0%
Minimum cash buffer	$250,000	9.4%
Total modeled external funding	**$2,648,209**	**100.0%**

Scenario spread makes staged capital essential



Scenario factors recalculate utilization, price, membership/events, operating cost, and opening capital. Funding figures include the modeled minimum cash buffer.

The downside case is existential: $5.13 million of funding and no five-year break-even. The upside case is investable only relative to the base: $2.12 million of funding and a 16.1% Year 5 EBITDA margin, with positive EBITDA in Year 4. Because the range is driven by variables a paid pilot can measure, committing flagship capital before validation would buy uncertainty rather than remove it.

RECOMMENDED CAPITAL SEQUENCE

Stage A: authorize a capped $150K–$250K validation budget for 90–180 days. Stage B: consider approximately $2.65M of flagship funding only after demand, delivery, privacy, pricing, and utilization gates are independently evidenced. Structure and sources of capital require tax and legal advice.

TEN STORES ARE NOT THE PLAN

16 Expansion stress test

The workbook includes an intentionally aggressive illustrative path to ten stores by Year 7: one initial store, another in Year 4, two in Year 5, three in Year 6, and three in Year 7. Each new store is assumed to follow the same slow maturation curve while central platform costs increase.

Metric	Year 4	Year 5	Year 6	Year 7
Total stores	2	4	7	10
Total store revenue	$2.346M	$4.325M	$7.317M	$11.308M
Consolidated EBITDA	**($1.127M)**	**($2.377M)**	**($4.262M)**	**($5.646M)**
Consolidated EBITDA margin	(48.1%)	(55.0%)	(58.3%)	(49.9%)
Cumulative growth capex	$1.995M	$3.995M	$6.995M	$9.995M

CONCLUSION

Do not franchise, roll out, or build central-platform overhead on the modeled maturation curve. Expansion should wait until one unit sustains attractive four-wall economics and the second unit reproduces them without founder heroics.

Expansion gates

- Trailing six-month four-wall EBITDA margin ≥15% after a normalized manager salary.
- Paid delivery utilization ≥70% without overtime or quality deterioration.
- At least 30% of business from repeat, referral, membership, or contracted partner channels.
- Second location opens within ±10% of approved capex and reaches breakeven within 24 months.
- Documented training, QA, privacy, and incident controls pass an external review.

WHAT CAN FAIL

17 Feasibility scorecard and principal risks

Dimension	Current score	Rationale	Next proof
Problem / demand	3 / 5	Need is plausible; willingness to pay unknown	Paid conversion by segment
Service delivery	4 / 5	Concierge workflow is feasible	Scope variance, QA, throughput
Flagship economics	2 / 5	Base margin weak and capital intensive	Pilot unit economics and local quotes
Technology	4 / 5	Can start with controlled existing tools	Security/privacy assessment
IP / legal	3 / 5	Manageable for services; higher risk in funding lane	Counsel-approved terms and boundaries
Scale / franchise	1 / 5	No replicated unit or playbook	Two profitable units and audited SOPs
Overall	**CONDITIONAL**	**Studio first; platform and rollout gated**	**90-day validation scorecard**

Principal risk register

Risk	Impact	Leading indicator	Mitigation
Customers choose free/DIY alternatives	High	Low diagnostic conversion	Sharper deliverables, segment focus, partner channels
Projects overrun	High	Hours/package exceed plan	Scope gates, revision caps, red-team templates
Underutilized fixed team	High	Paid utilization below 50%	Variable staffing, cohorts, partner-hosted format
Confidentiality or AI incident	Critical	Control exception / complaint	Consent, access, encryption, deletion, response plan
Funding claims create regulatory exposure	Critical	Staff implies guarantees or transaction role	Training, scripts, counsel, registered intermediaries
Brand alienates target customers	Medium	Negative unaided name reaction	Blind testing, alternate names, trademark review
Buildout and lease overrun	High	Bids exceed allowance	Short pilot, landlord concessions, fixed bids, contingencies

THE NEXT CAPITAL SHOULD BUY ANSWERS

18 Ninety-day validation program

Period	Work	Evidence produced
Days 1–15	Counsel issue list; customer interviews; name test; package prototypes; partner outreach	Risk boundaries, scripts, first demand map
Days 16–45	Twelve paid concierge engagements; time tracking; three price cells; artifact QA	Realized rate, scope variance, customer value
Days 46–75	Partner-hosted clinics/pop-up; cohort workshop; referral tests; security tabletop	Channel conversion, throughput, incident readiness
Days 76–90	Repeat sales; second-review audit; updated model; IC decision	Measured economics and go/pivot/stop recommendation

Hard gates for a lease search

- At least 100 paid engagements or an equivalent contracted revenue base across the validation period.
- Three-month trailing revenue run-rate of at least $100K per month or a credible contracted bridge to it.
- Blended service revenue per paid delivery hour ≥$200 and package contribution margin ≥65% after specialist pass-through.
- Paid utilization ≥60% in a lean delivery team, with premium-deliverable rework below 15%.
- Lead-to-paid conversion ≥20%, acquisition payback ≤90 days, and repeat/referral share ≥30%.
- NPS ≥50, no critical privacy/confidentiality incidents, and counsel-approved customer terms.
- Two local site scenarios with signed landlord economics, contractor ranges, and downside covenant headroom.

DECISION RULE

Missing one hard gate does not automatically kill the venture; it forces a documented remedy, a lower-capital format, or a stop decision before a long-term obligation.

OPTIONALITY BY DESIGN

19 Twenty-four-month roadmap

Stage	Months	Objective	Exit criterion
Discovery	0–2	Prove target problem and paid diagnostic	12 paid cases; no critical control gap
Concierge studio	2–6	Prove offer mix, delivery, and referrals	Economics and quality thresholds met
Pop-up / embedded studio	6–12	Prove location-assisted acquisition and events	Sustained run-rate and utilization
Flagship diligence	9–15	Site, bids, financing, security, team	IC approval against downside case
Flagship launch	15–24	Operate one controlled unit	Six months of stable four-wall KPIs
Platform options	18+	Rewards partnerships; investor lane design	Qualified pipeline, counsel, intermediary partners
Replication	After proof	Open second company-owned unit	Reproducible economics and playbook

What stays deferred

- Proprietary crowdfunding infrastructure, customer fund custody, or transaction processing.
- Investor marketplace economics or transaction-dependent fees.
- Custom AI model training on customer ideas.
- Franchise sales, area development, or a ten-store capital plan.
- Permanent flagship signage or major buildout before name and site validation.

MAKE THE GATES OPERATIONAL

20 Management dashboard and decision rights

Dashboard	Weekly	Monthly	Quarterly / gate
Demand	Leads, bookings, conversion	CAC, payback, channel mix	Segment and market decision
Delivery	Hours, WIP, scope exceptions	Utilization, realized rate, rework	Package/pricing reset
Customer	Completion, issues	NPS, referrals, outcomes	Promise and quality review
Financial	Revenue, cash, commitments	P&L, forecast, runway	Capital and lease gate
Risk	Access/control exceptions	Incidents, deletion, claims audit	Counsel/security review
People	Capacity, schedule	Training, quality, retention	Staffing architecture

Decision rights

The Managing Partner / IC Lead owns go/no-go decisions after written recommendations from the financial, market, operating, product, and risk workstreams. The Store GM owns normal customer and scheduling decisions within approved scope. Privacy, security, IP, and securities exceptions require a named specialist approver. No sales goal can override a stop, referral, or disclosure obligation.

SINGLE SOURCE OF TRUTH

The live financial workbook, evidence register, assumptions log, decision log, and current prospectus version together form the operating record. Marketing slides may summarize them but may not silently change the underlying case.

A PROSPECTUS, NOT AN OFFERING

21 Capital strategy and prospective fit

The venture should seek capital that matches the proof stage. The first dollars should fund experiments, secure delivery, and decision-quality data. A conventional multi-unit retail story is premature; an evidence-driven service-and-platform option is more credible.

Capital stage	Indicative need	Appropriate use	Potential fit
Validation	$150K–$250K	Discovery, paid cases, pop-up, legal/security, prototype brand	Founder capital, aligned angels, grants/sponsors, revenue
Flagship	~$2.65M base modeled need	Opening uses, operating ramp, cash buffer	Patient equity, strategic partners; structure after advice
Platform / replication	Not yet estimable	Technology, central team, second unit	Only after four-wall and compliance proof

Prospective partner profile

- Values customer outcomes and controlled experimentation over vanity store count.
- Can contribute founder distribution, community partnerships, professional-service operations, retail service design, or regulated-platform experience.
- Accepts that a kill, pivot, or low-capital format may be the correct result of validation.
- Does not require securities activity, franchise sales, or unproven revenue to support the initial thesis.

Any actual financing process requires a separate capital plan, entity and tax analysis, investor materials, risk disclosures, governance terms, and counsel-reviewed offering pathway. The financial model's "required financing" line is a cash-need calculation, not a proposed security.

PRESERVE THE AMBITION BY SEQUENCING IT

22 Conclusion

Lame Brain Ideas is feasible as a paid idea-development studio. Its storefront warmth, named guides, visible workflow, and tangible exits can make professional innovation support accessible to customers who will not enter an accelerator or hire a traditional consultancy. Existing AI tools make the service faster, but they also make undifferentiated advice easier to substitute. The company must therefore earn trust through facilitation, evidence, privacy, judgment, and outputs.

It is not yet feasible as a capital-heavy flagship network or vertically integrated funding platform. The base financial model reaches only $75K of Year 5 EBITDA on $2.01M of revenue after requiring approximately $2.65M in external funding. The downside is severe, and the illustrative ten-store rollout compounds losses. Those facts are not reasons to abandon the idea; they are reasons to run the right experiment.

FINAL RECOMMENDATION

Authorize a lean, paid, secure 90-day validation program with a capped budget and hard gates. Update the model with actuals. Proceed to a pop-up, then a flagship, only when the economics and controls—not enthusiasm—justify the next obligation.

Immediate owner actions

1. Approve or revise the customer promise, beachhead segment, four working packages, and no-guarantee funding boundary.
2. Commission the legal/privacy issue list and brand/trademark screening before public intake.
3. Recruit 12 paid concierge customers and three partner hosts; track time, evidence, conversion, quality, and outcomes.
4. Replace rent, buildout, insurance, wage, software, and specialist assumptions with local quotes.
5. Reconvene the investment committee at Day 90 with the updated workbook and a go/pivot/stop memorandum.

MODEL MECHANICS

A Financial appendix

Revenue logic

Paid delivery hours = delivery FTE × available client hours per FTE × paid utilization. Package engagements = paid delivery hours × package hours mix ÷ delivery hours per engagement. Service revenue = engagements × price. Membership, events, lab add-ons, rewards fees, and investor memberships are modeled separately; rewards and investor revenue remain explicitly gated.

Cash logic

Unlevered cash flow = EBITDA – cash taxes – change in net working capital – maintenance capital – opening uses. Required financing equals the most negative cumulative cash position plus the minimum cash buffer. The model assumes financing arrives pre-open and does not model debt interest, financing fees, valuation, ownership dilution, or investor returns.

Scenario logic

Driver	Downside	Base	Upside
Utilization factor	0.8×	1.0×	1.2×
Price factor	0.9×	1.0×	1.1×
Membership/event factor	0.7×	1.0×	1.3×
Operating cost factor	1.1×	1.0×	1.1×
Opening capex factor	1.2×	1.0×	1.0×

All outputs should be read with the live workbook. The workbook includes separate Assumptions, Unit Economics, P&L, Cash Flow, Scenarios, Ten-Store Rollout, Checks, and Sources sheets. Formula checks confirm structural consistency, not commercial truth.

PRIMARY AND AUTHORITATIVE EVIDENCE

B Research source register

[S1] Frequently Asked Questions About Small Business, 2026. U.S. Small Business Administration Office of Advocacy. Small-business counts, nonemployer share, AI-use estimates, openings, and survival. Source

[S2] Business Formation Statistics, June 2026. U.S. Census Bureau. Business applications and projected employer startups; released 9 July 2026. Source

[S3] SCORE's Small Business Services. SCORE. No-cost, confidential mentoring benchmark. Source

[S4] Small Business Development Centers. U.S. Small Business Administration. Individualized advising and technical-assistance benchmark. Source

[S5] What are the fees?. Kickstarter Support. 5% platform fee plus roughly 3%–5% payment processing on successfully funded projects. Source

[S6] Fees & Pricing for Campaigners. Indiegogo Support. 5% platform fee plus payment processing. Source

[S7] Q1 2026 U.S. Retail Figures. CBRE. Average asking rent, availability, and suburban-versus-downtown context. Source

[S8] Management Analysts. U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics. May 2024 median pay and 2024–34 outlook. Source

[S9] Market Research Analysts. U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics. May 2024 median pay and 2024–34 outlook. Source

[S10] AI Risk Management Framework. National Institute of Standards and Technology. Voluntary AI-risk governance framework. Source

[S11] Copyright and Artificial Intelligence, Part 2: Copyrightability. U.S. Copyright Office. Human-authorship analysis for generative-AI outputs. Source

[S12] Revised Inventorship Guidance for AI-Assisted Inventions. U.S. Patent and Trademark Office. Natural-person inventorship and AI as a tool. Source

[S13] Regulation Crowdfunding. U.S. Securities and Exchange Commission. Offering limit and registered-intermediary requirements. Source

[S14] Franchise Rule. U.S. Federal Trade Commission. Federal franchise disclosure framework. Source

[S15] Regulation Crowdfunding Offerings. U.S. Securities and Exchange Commission. Offering and reported-proceeds statistics through 31 December 2025. Source

Source-concept record

Public ChatGPT share: Lame Brain Ideas Plan. Accessed 17 July 2026. The share contained one user prompt and one assistant response; no Canvas or file attachments were recoverable.

READ BEFORE RELIANCE

C Important qualifications

- The financial model is based on management assumptions. No historical operating data exists in the source package.
- National data does not establish local demand, rent, wage, buildout, insurance, or customer-acquisition economics.
- The word “validated” means evidence was collected against stated criteria; it does not guarantee commercial, technical, legal, or funding success.
- Crowdfunding proceeds and platform activity are contextual evidence, not revenue forecasts for Lame Brain Ideas.
- Customer confidentiality cannot be guaranteed absolutely. Controls reduce risk and must be described honestly.
- AI-assisted work can contain errors, omissions, bias, unlicensed material, or unsupported claims; human review and specialist referral remain essential.
- Any securities, franchise, IP, privacy, employment, lease, tax, or consumer-protection decision requires jurisdiction-specific professional advice.

The recommended next action is validation, not fundraising promotion. This prospectus should be updated when pilot evidence, bids, counsel advice, and actual customer outcomes replace assumptions.